Therefore, $x = 12, -\frac{4}{7}$.

Here $x = -\frac{4}{7}$ is not possible as the number of swans cannot be negative.

Hence, $x = 12$. Therefore total number of swans is $x^2 = 144$.

Example 3.39 A passenger train takes 1 hr more than an express train to travel a distance of 240 km from Chennai to Virudhachalam. The speed of passenger train is less than that of an express train by 20 km per hour. Find the average speed of both the trains.

Solution Let the average speed of passenger train be x km/hr.

Then the average speed of express train will be $(x + 20)$ km/hr

Time taken by the passenger train to cover distance of 240 km $= \frac{240}{x}$ hr

Time taken by express train to cover distance of 240 km $= \frac{240}{x+20}$ hr

Given, $\frac{240}{x} = \frac{240}{x+20} + 1$

$240\left[\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{x+20}\right] = 1 \Rightarrow 240\left[\frac{x+20-x}{x(x+20)}\right] = 1$ we get, $4800 = (x^2 + 20x)$

$x^2 + 20x - 4800 = 0 \Rightarrow (x + 80)(x - 60) = 0$ we get, $x = -80$ or 60.

Therefore $x = 60$ (Rejecting -80 as speed cannot be negative)

Average speed of the passenger train is 60 km/hr

Average speed of the express train is 80 km/hr.

Exercise 3.12

1. If the difference between a number and its reciprocal is $\frac{24}{5}$, find the number.
2. A garden measuring 12m by 16m is to have a pedestrian pathway that is 'w' meters wide installed all the way around so that it increases the total area to 285 m^2. What is the width of the pathway?
3. A bus covers a distance of 90 km at a uniform speed. Had the speed been 15 km/hour more it would have taken 30 minutes less for the journey. Find the original speed of the bus.
4. A girl is twice as old as her sister. Five years hence, the product of their ages (in years) will be 375. Find their present ages.
5. A pole has to be erected at a point on the boundary of a circular ground of diameter 20 m in such a way that the difference of its distances from two diametrically opposite fixed gates P and Q on the boundary is 4 m. Is it possible to do so? If answer is yes at what distance from the two gates should the pole be erected?
6. From a group of $2x^2$ black bees , square root of half of the group went to a tree. Again eight-ninth of the bees went to the same tree. The remaining two got caught up in a fragrant lotus. How many bees were there in total?

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